PRODUCT CASE STUDY

Rejoined Employee Feature

How a single customer conversation eliminated
the pain of re-onboarding employees who return to an organisation

Customer-Driven Discovery | Smart Autofill | Admin & Employee Control | 1-Month Delivery

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02 The Problem

ORIGIN

A customer conversation that revealed a hidden pain point

While speaking with a customer, we noticed they had a high volume of returning employees. Staff who had left and rejoined the organisation after 4 to 5 years.

Despite the system having all their previous data, every returning employee had to go through the complete onboarding process from scratch like collecting documents, filling forms, and re-entering all their information as if they were brand new.

We validated this with more customers and confirmed it was a widespread, unaddressed pain point across the platform.

Insight: Existing data was being ignored and the system wasn't working for the customer

Duplicate Work for Admins

Admins had to manually collect all documents, information, and forms again from returning employees even though the system already held their previous records.

Frustrating Experience for Employees

Returning employees, who already knew the organisation, had to re-enter every personal detail, re-submit documents, and redo their entire onboarding as if they were strangers.

No System-Level Recognition

greytHR had no way to flag or recognise a returning employee. Every add-employee flow was treated identically regardless of prior history.

03

My Role & Process

Team: PM + 2–3 Engineers · Timeline: 1 Month

Key Design Decision: Autofill with full edit rights and not a locked or read-only view. The employee's previous data is a starting point, not a constraint. Both admin and employee retain complete control to update any detail.

1 Discovery

Customer conversation identified the pain
Validated with multiple customers
Confirmed platform-wide need

2 Define & Design

Defined autofill logic using any identification number
Designed admin and employee flows
Wrote PRD & stories

3 Build & Test

Built with 2–3 engineers
QA: edge cases for partial data and info changes
Usability testing

4 Launch

Released within Add Employee page
Available to all greytHR customers
Fast adoption observed

04 The Solution

A smart autofill flow inside the existing Add Employee page was introduced to recognize returning employees and pre-populating everything, while keeping admin and employee fully in control.

Admin searches returning employee by name or ID number

System matches record & auto-fills add employee & onboarding forms

Admin reviews and updates any changed details before confirming

Employee receives autofilled form and updates only what has changed

WHAT MADE THIS DECISION RIGHT

- Autofill as a starting point and not a locked record. Admin and employee always retain edit rights to reflect life changes over 4-5 years.
- Employee identification number works as the lookup key, and avoids duplicate entries of the employees
- Both admin AND employee get the autofilled experience, saving effort on both sides of the onboarding, not just one.

05 Outcome & Learnings

1

Month from discovery to launch

Fast

Customer adoption after release

2x

Both admin & employee sides were served

Delivered in 1 month by a small team of 2–3 engineers. The feature was adopted quickly after release giving a strong signal that it addressed a real, felt pain point that customers had simply learned to live with.

LEARNINGS

- The most valuable features are sometimes hiding in plain sight. One customer conversation surfaced a pain point that the entire platform had quietly accepted as normal
- Speed matters for small, well-scoped features
- Design for real life, not ideal conditions such as autofill with edit rights acknowledges that an employee’s details genuinely change over 4–5 years, rather than assuming data is static